AMBROXOL

Mucolytic

Throat lozenges for sore throat

CHEMICAL NAME trans-4-[(2-amino-3,5-dibromobenzyl)amino]cyclohexanol (hydrochloride)

CLASS Mucolytic / secretolytic agent (bromhexine metabolite)

TRADE NAMES Mucosolvan · Lasolvan · Ambrolex · Mucolin

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Acute and chronic bronchopulmonary diseases with thick, sticky mucus (bronchitis, COPD).
- Sore throat (lozenges — local anaesthetic effect).
- Neonatal respiratory distress (historical IV use).

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** syrup, tablets or drops after meals with plenty of fluid.
- **Inhalation** solution via nebuliser.
- **Lozenges** dissolved slowly.

DOSAGES

- **Adult:** 30 mg three times daily for 2–3 days, then 30 mg twice daily (or 75 mg SR once daily).
- **Children 6–12 yr:** 15 mg 2–3 times daily.
- **2–5 yr:** 7.5 mg three times daily.
- **<2 yr:** 7.5 mg twice daily (medical advice).

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** 30 min. **Duration:** 6–12 h.
- Metabolised in liver (CYP3A4).
- Excreted in urine. **t½:** 7–12 h.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Stimulates **serous secretion** and ↑ surfactant production; breaks mucopolysaccharide fibres → thinner mucus.
- Enhances mucociliary clearance; local anaesthetic (Na^+ channel block); ↑ antibiotic penetration into secretions.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Nausea, dyspepsia, diarrhoea.
- Taste disturbance.
- Numbness of mouth/throat.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Severe skin reactions (SJS/TEN, AGEP); stop at first rash.
- Anaphylaxis (rare).

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Hypersensitivity.
- **Caution:** peptic ulcer, severe renal/hepatic impairment, impaired cough reflex, first trimester.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Antitussives:** avoid combination (mucus retention).
- **Antibiotics (amoxicillin, cefuroxime, erythromycin):** ↑ lung tissue concentrations.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Encourage fluids, chest physiotherapy, deep breathing.
- Assess sputum consistency and ease of expectoration.
- Stop and report any skin rash.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Drink plenty of water.
- Do not combine with cough suppressants.
- Stop and seek advice if a rash, blisters or mouth sores appear.

KEY POINTS

- Mucolytic — thins mucus, ↑ surfactant.
- Do not combine with cough suppressants.
- 30 mg TDS (adult).
- Stop if rash (SJS).